

# Illustration:

## Texts That Give Examples

### Understand What Illustration Is

**Illustration** is writing that uses examples to support a point.

#### Four Basics of Good Illustration

- 1** It has a point to communicate to readers.
- 2** It provides examples that show, explain, or prove the point.
- 3** It gives specific details to support the examples.
- 4** It presents examples in order of importance or when they happened.

In the following paragraph, the numbers and colors correspond to the Four Basics of Good Illustration.

**1** Many people would like to serve their communities or help with causes that they believe in, but they do not have much time and do not know what to do. Now, the Internet provides people with ways to help that do not take much time or money. **2** Web sites now make it convenient to donate online. With a few clicks, an organization of your choice can receive your donation or money from a sponsoring advertiser. Some examples of click-to-give sites are [www.thechildhealthsite.com](http://www.thechildhealthsite.com), [www.theliteracysite.com](http://www.theliteracysite.com), and [www.breastcancersite.com](http://www.breastcancersite.com). **3** These sites have click-to-give links, online stores that direct a percentage of sales income to charity, and links to help you learn about causes you are interested in. One hundred percent of the sponsors' donations go to the charities, and you can give with a click every single day. **2** Similarly, if you are interested in helping rescue unwanted and abandoned animals, you can go to [www.theanimalrescuesite.com](http://www.theanimalrescuesite.com). **3** When you click as instructed, a sponsoring advertiser will make a donation to

**4** Enough examples provided

4 Enough examples provided

help provide food and care for the 27 million animals in shelters. Also, a portion of any money you spend in the site's online store will go to providing animal care. **2** Finally, if your goal is much bigger, such as fighting world hunger, you can go to [www.thehungersite.com](http://www.thehungersite.com) **3** and click daily to have sponsor fees directed to hungry people in more than seventy countries via the Mercy Corps, Feeding America, and Millennium Promise. Each year, hundreds of millions of cups of food are distributed to one billion hungry people around the world. Since I have found out about sites like these, I go to at least one of them every day. **1** I have learned a lot about various problems, and every day I feel as if I have helped a little.

It is hard to explain anything or understand difficult concepts without using examples, so you read, write, and speak with illustration in almost every communication situation. In college, you may read case studies that illustrate concepts from psychology or sociology, or your instructor may ask you to give examples of concepts or principles for a history or nursing exam. At work, you may need to read examples of specific customer complaints to understand how to make improvements to a product, or your boss may ask you to illustrate a problem to justify a budget increase request. In everyday life, you may look at examples to help you make a purchase, or you may include examples in a cover letter when you apply for a job.

In college, the words *illustration* and *illustrate* may not appear in assignments. Instead, you may be asked to *give examples* of something or to *be specific* about something. In addition, you may be asked to *find examples* or *instances* of something when you are reading. Regardless of how an assignment is worded, good readers and writers find and use specific examples in order to be clear and effective.

## Reading Illustration

When you read an article or essay with examples, pay attention to how and why the author is using examples. Some authors provide multiple examples, while others may focus on a single, extended example. In either case, the writers have chosen examples purposefully to illustrate their theses, and critical readers should assess the effectiveness of those examples. Specifically, critical readers ask three questions:

- *Are the examples sufficient?* Are there enough examples to make the point?
- *Are the examples representative?* Are they typical?
- *Are the examples fair?* Do they provide a balanced view of the topic? Are relevant examples left out? Do the examples manipulate a reader's emotions?

Analyzing and evaluating how a writer has used examples in illustration will help you read more effectively, and it will help you understand the choices you must make when you write illustration.

### *Illustration in the Classroom: Résumés*

Ryan is taking a student development course called College and Career Success Skills at his community college. The instructor asked the students to prepare a résumé for a mock job interview. Ryan's goal is to get a degree in landscape design and business management so that he can own his own landscaping company. While in school, he hopes to continue working with landscaping companies to improve his understanding of the business. Ryan knew that a résumé includes previous work experience in time order, so he submitted the following section as part of his résumé:

#### **Work Experience**

|              |                                                 |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 2011–present | A and G Landscaping, assistant                  |
| 2010–2011    | Intern, Martin High School Landscaping Division |
| 2008–2010    | Self-employed, lawn cutting and maintenance     |

The instructor returned the draft of the résumé with two comments:

*Jason, what do you want a potential employer to know about you, based on your work history? Can you add any details to the Work Experience section of your résumé to help you make this point?*

Ryan's instructor was asking him to apply the Four Basics of Good Illustration. First, he needed to use his résumé to make a point: he was experienced in many aspects of landscaping. His work history showed three good examples of experience, but he needed to give details to support the examples so that his examples would be strong enough to make his point to an employer. A résumé requires presenting work experience in time order from most to least recent.

Ryan submitted the following revision to his instructor:

### Work Experience

#### 2011–present      Assistant, A and G Landscaping

- Managed site crew (mowing, trimming, planting, mulching, and fertilizing)
- Completed paperwork for client review
- Managed/maintained equipment for site crew
- Assisted manager with site review process

#### 2010–2011      Intern, Martin High School Landscaping Division

- Worked with Martin High School crew to maintain football fields, soccer field, baseball fields, and track area

#### 2008–2010      Self-employed, Lawn Care and Maintenance

- Cut and maintained lawns (watering, trimming, fertilizing) for fifteen clients

Ryan and his instructor agreed that the second version was much better at providing the specific examples and details that would support Ryan's main goal of obtaining a part-time job.

### PRACTICE 8-1

### Identify Illustration in Résumés and Textbooks

1. *Explore your résumé.* Each section of a résumé (education, work experience, activities and community service, awards and accomplishments, references) helps a prospective employer understand who you are. What do the examples in your résumé say about you? Exchange résumés with a classmate. Write a short paragraph about your classmate, using the examples on the résumé as support.
2. *Explore a textbook.* Many textbooks, including this one, use examples to make points clear. Identify supporting examples in a textbook. How do those examples support the point of the chapter? What would happen if the examples were removed? Explain.



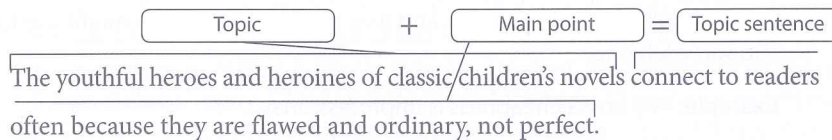
## First Basic: Main Point in Illustration

In illustration, the main point is the message that the writer wants the readers to receive and understand through the examples given; the message may be a belief, concept, or generalization, and the examples serve as evidence for the main point. When you are reading illustration, it is easy to focus on the specific examples and miss the point the writer is making. In fact, some writers do not state their main point directly; in that case, readers must infer the main point by considering what the examples share in common.

To discover a writer's main point or to draft your own main point, complete the following sentence:

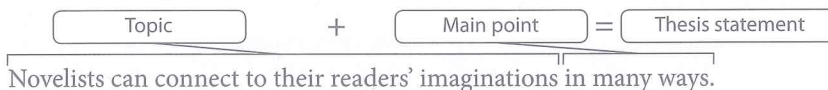
These examples show that . . .

The topic sentence (in a paragraph) or thesis statement (in an essay) usually includes the topic and the main point the writer wants to make about the topic. If you are struggling to find the main idea in an illustration essay, look for a common feature that links the examples provided, and identify a general word or phrase that names that feature. For example, consider the paragraph on page 140, which mentions four examples of imperfect main characters in a children's story: Peter Pevensie (proud), Edmund Pevensie (jealous), Susan Pevensie (nagging), and Lucy Pevensie (bitter). Here is the topic sentence for that paragraph:



*Flawed* and *ordinary* are general terms that capture the common feature of all four supporting examples.

Remember that the thesis statement for an essay can be a little broader than a paragraph topic.



Whereas the topic sentence focuses on just one novel, the thesis statement for the essay considers novels in general.

**PRACTICE 8-2** Identify Main Points in Illustration

1. Write the topic sentence for the sample paragraph on page 129, and diagram it to show the topic and main point.
2. Write the topic sentence for Inez King's paragraph on page 142, and diagram it to show the topic and main point.

## Second Basic: Appropriate Examples

The paragraph and essay models on pages 140–41 include the support used in all illustration writing: examples backed up by details about the examples. In the essay model, however, the major support points (examples) are topic sentences for individual paragraphs that are developed with specific examples and details.

Writers choose major supporting examples that will best illustrate their main point. There is no perfect number of examples; a single, extended example might work well to illustrate how angry our political discussions have become, while as many as ten to fifteen examples might be needed to illustrate how English grammar causes problems for adult second-language learners. As you select major examples, make sure that you include a sufficient number of examples that are relevant (related to the main point), representative (typical), and fair.

**PRACTICE 8-3** Write Supporting Points for Illustration

Read the following main points, and give three examples you might use to support each one.

**Example:** My boss's cheapness is unprofessional.

makes us bring in our own calculators

makes us use old, rusted paper clips

will not replace burned-out lightbulbs

1. My (friend, sister, brother, husband, wife—choose one) has some admirable traits.
2. This weekend is particularly busy.

## Third Basic: Specific Details

Effective examples in illustration are supported by specific details, which may include sensory details and dialogue (see Chapter 7). In addition, writers of illustration may use proper nouns, quotes, and hypothetical examples to support their main idea.

### Using Proper Nouns

In her essay, “The Weirdest Job Interview Questions and How to Handle Them” (pp. 145–47), Susan Adams mentions a Maserati and a Bentley. These two words are examples of **proper nouns**. A proper noun is a name, and it is always capitalized. A proper name is always more specific than other nouns, because it names something specific. Adams could have used the word “car” (very general) or “luxury car” (more specific), but she chose to use two proper nouns that are even more specific. A proper name helps readers visualize and connect more easily with examples, as long as the readers are familiar with the names that are mentioned. In this case, Adams assumed her readers would recognize that both Maseratis and Bentleys are luxury cars, but the Maserati is associated with speed, while a Bentley is associated with elegance.

### Incorporating Quotes

Both of the professional readings in this chapter include quotes from experts among their examples. A quote is similar to dialogue in punctuation and formatting: both have a signal phrase, and both use quotation marks. However, dialogue captures a spoken conversation in writing, while a quote is either the written or spoken words of a single person. Look at the following paragraph from Susan Adams’ essay, “The Weirdest Job Interview Questions and How to Handle Them.” To support her point, she quotes an expert named Rusty Rueff.

No matter where you apply for work, there is a chance you could get a question from left field. According to Rusty Rueff—a consultant at Glassdoor who is the author of *Talent Force: A New Manifesto for the Human Side of Business* and former head of human resources at PepsiCo and Electronic Arts—most job applicants are woefully unprepared for off-the-wall questions. “Ninety percent of people don’t know how to deal with them,” he says. Like me, they freeze and their minds go blank.

Adams quotes Rueff, but while Adams could assume her readers would recognize the names of luxury cars, she could not assume her readers would know who Rusty Rueff is or why he is qualified to address her topic. When writers introduce an expert, they also include the expert's credentials. **Credentials** explain *why* someone qualifies as an expert. Rueff's credentials appear in the second sentence of the paragraph: "a consultant at Glassdoor who is the author of *Talent Force: A New Manifesto for the Human Side of Business* and former head of human resources at PepsiCo and Electronic Arts." In between dashes, Adams lists Rueff's current job, a book he wrote, and a previous job as evidence of his qualifications on the topic.

### Devising Hypothetical Examples

Mentioning proper names and quoting experts are widely recognized strategies for making examples more effective in illustration. Sometimes, however, writers don't know actual examples, so they cannot use proper nouns or quotes. Instead, they may create **hypothetical** examples: situations that could be possible but aren't actual events. Writers who are using hypothetical examples often use one of these expressions to introduce them:

- Say, let's say
- Imagine, let's imagine
- Suppose
- What if

See if you can identify the hypothetical example in the following paragraph:

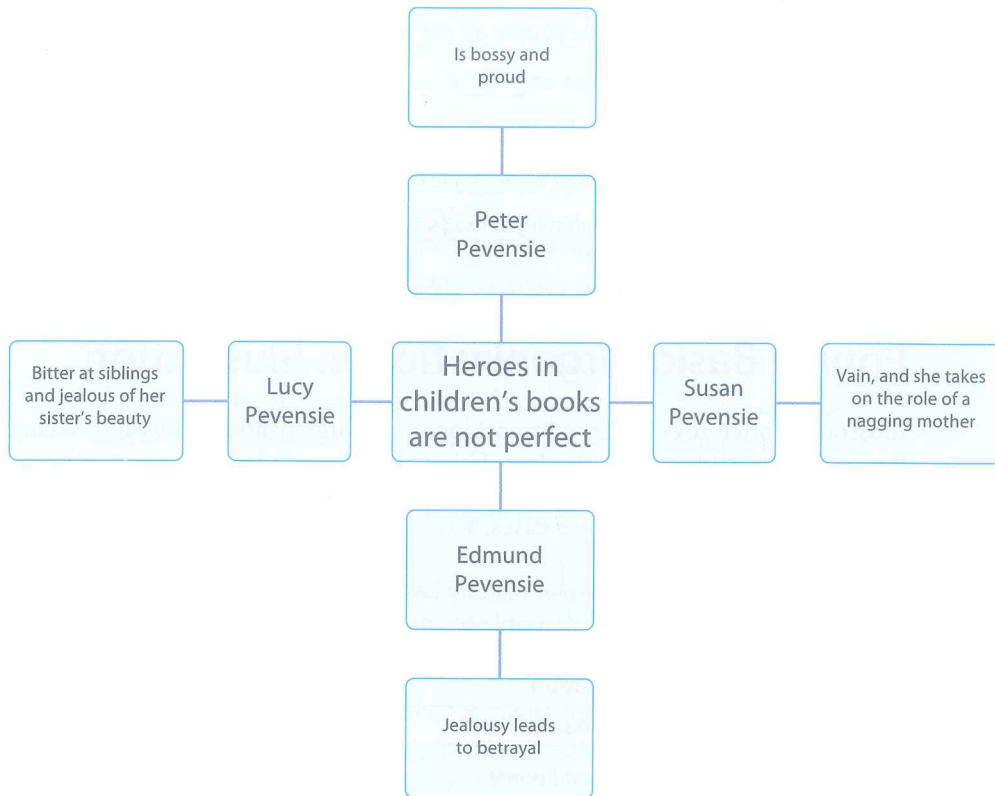
Screencasting is an incredibly useful technology for college instructors. Let's say, for example, that a student develops a case of pneumonia and must miss two weeks of class. Does that student need to drop the course? Not if the instructor uses screencasting. In this case, the instructor can capture his PowerPoint notes, video, and audio in a single file that can be shared online. The student who cannot be in the classroom can catch up from home.

This writer does not know a real student with pneumonia or an instructor who uses screencasting to record class material. This is a hypothetical example that begins with the words, "let's say, for example." However, the example illustrates the point the writer is making: that "screencasting is an incredibly useful technology for college instructors."



### Using a Graphic Organizer

Graphic organizers can help readers and writers identify support in illustration. Consider the following graphic organizer for the paragraph on page 140. The center box contains the main point, while each box connected to the center lists a major supporting example. The outermost boxes contain details that support the major examples.



#### PRACTICE 8-4

#### Use Graphic Organizers to Identify Minor Details

Create a graphic organizer similar to the one above to show the main idea, major support, and minor supporting details for Inez King's essay, "Empathy," p. 142.

**PRACTICE 8-5** Write Details about the Examples

Using your main points and examples from Practice 8-3 (p. 134), write a detail that further shows, explains, or proves what you mean.

**Example**

Main point: My boss's cheapness is unprofessional.

Example: makes us bring in our own calculators

Detail: Some people do not have a calculator.

Example: makes us use old, rusted paper clips

Detail: They leave rust marks on important documents.

Example: will not replace burned-out lightbulbs

Detail: The dim light leads to more errors.

## Fourth Basic: Organization in Illustration

Illustration often uses order of importance as an organizational method, saving the most powerful example for last. This strategy is used in the paragraph and essay models on pages 140–41. Sometimes, the examples are given according to when they happened. In those cases, writers are using **time order** to organize their writing.

Transitions in illustration let readers know that the writer is introducing an example or moving from one example to another.

**Common Transitions in Illustration**

| Conjunctive Adverbials    | Adjectives | Nouns              |
|---------------------------|------------|--------------------|
| also                      | additional | another example    |
| finally                   | another    | another instance   |
| first, second, next, etc. | last       | as an illustration |
| for example               | next       | one example        |
| for instance              | one        | one instance       |
| specifically              | the least  | to demonstrate     |
| in addition               | the most   |                    |
| moreover                  | specific   |                    |

For information on using and punctuating these transitions, see Chapters 17 and 24.

**PRACTICE 8-6 Identify Transitions in Illustration**

1. Circle or list the transitions in the sample paragraph on page 140. What pattern of organization does this paragraph follow? How do you know?
2. Circle or list the transitions in the paragraph by Inez King on page 142. What pattern of organization does this paragraph follow? How do you know?
3. After you complete Practice 8-7, determine what pattern of organization the paragraph follows. How do you know?

**PRACTICE 8-7 Use Transitions in Illustration**

Read the paragraph that follows, and fill in the blanks with transitions.

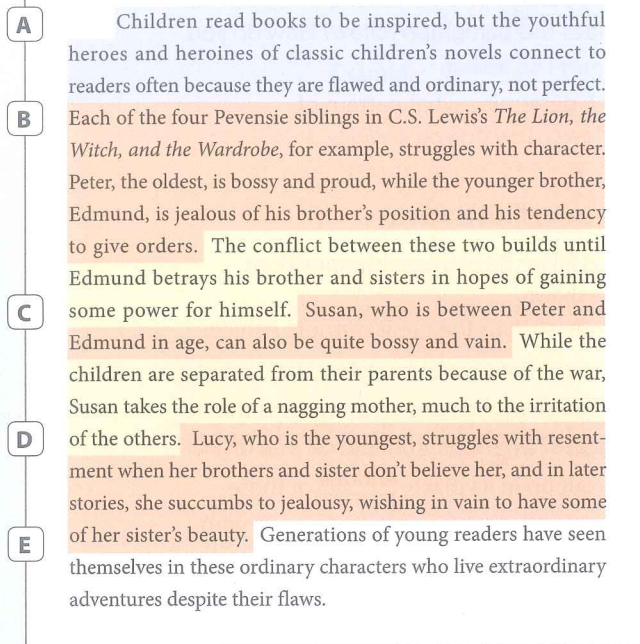
Answers will vary. Possible answers are shown.

Greek myths include many heroes, such as the great warriors Achilles and Herakles. In addition, the myths describe several monsters that tested the heroes' strength. One example of these frightening creatures was the Hydra, a water serpent with many heads. When a warrior cut off one of these heads, two or more would sprout up in its place. Another of these mythical monsters was Medusa, who had snakes for hair. Any person who looked into her eyes would turn to stone. The most terrifying monster was Cerberus, a three-headed dog with snapping jaws. He guarded the gates to the underworld, keeping the living from entering and the dead from leaving. Fortunately, some heroes' cleverness equaled the monsters' hideousness. For instance, Herakles discovered that by applying a torch to the wounds of the Hydra, he could prevent the creature from growing more heads. Also, Orpheus, a famous mythical musician, soothed Cerberus by plucking the strings of a lyre. In this way, Orpheus got past the beast and entered the underworld, from which he hoped to rescue his wife.

## Paragraphs vs. Essays in Illustration

For more on the important features of illustration, see the Four Basics of Good Illustration on page 129.

### Paragraph Form



**Main Point:** Often narrower for a paragraph than for an essay: while the topic sentence (paragraph) is focused on just one children's book, the thesis statement (essay) discusses a variety of types of novel.

**Support:** examples support the main point.

**Details:** Usually, 1 to 3 sentences per example for paragraphs and 3 to 8 sentences per example for essays.

**Conclusion**

- A** Topic sentence
- B** Support 1 (first example)
- C** Support 2 (second example)
- D** Support 3 (third example)
- E** Concluding sentence

## Think Critically as You Read and Write Illustration

### Ask yourself when reading . . .

- What is the writer's main point?
- Is the writer using one extended example or several examples?
- Has the writer provided enough examples to support the main point?
- Are the examples relevant? Do they provide a balanced picture?

### Ask yourself when writing . . .

- Should I use one extended example or a series of examples?
- Is each of my current examples clearly related to the main point?
- If my paragraph or essay feels "thin," might I find relevant new examples to enrich it? (See p. 135 on idea generation.)



## Essay Form

Novel Love, by Katie Horn

1

Reading provides great joy; from newspapers to cereal boxes to blogs about physics, people seek to satisfy their craving for words, stories, and escape from everyday worries. This is why, of all the forms of reading material available to us, we often choose novels. Novels unravel tales filled with suspense, heroism, romance, and adventure. In penning fiction, every novelist's goal is to captivate readers; there are many ways that novelists can connect to their readers' imaginations.

For example, mystery novelists engage readers' thinking skills. As characters uncover clues, the writer challenges the reader to assemble the puzzle pieces and solve the mystery before the characters do. In this way, the readers become the world-class detectives and unassuming gumshoes they admire on the page. The most talented mystery novelists often withhold a tidbit of truth from readers, waiting until the last moment to reveal the pivotal detail. Agatha Christie does this in *And Then There Were None*, in which the murderer is not revealed until a telltale manuscript is discovered in the epilogue. Because of such challenges,

A

B

3

they encourage people to embrace wonderment. But reading for escape is more than entertainment; many fantasy writers use their stories to reveal truth about what it means to be human. One of the most famous examples of this is C. S. Lewis's children's novel *The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe*, a whimsical tale about siblings who travel to a snowy kingdom inside a closet. However, careful readers will recognize a battle between good and evil and a wealth of Christian symbolism. By grappling with topics, such as loyalty, purpose, betrayal, and faith in the context of an alternate universe, fantasy writers allow readers to deal with these issues at their own pace. Readers revisit fantasy for the opportunity to explore new worlds and to consider human experience.

Finally, novelists engage readers by exploring answers to the question "what if?" For example, science fiction writers take readers to an augmented reality. Beginning with a familiar reality, the author introduces a new scientific advancement that changes the very state of that reality. For example, what begins as a commonplace dinner party in H. G. Wells' novel *The Time Machine* quickly becomes an adventure in

E

2

readers continue to seek new mystery titles, hungry for fresh plots to hone their armchair detective skills.

Novelists also rely on readers' insatiable curiosity: They tease readers to press through "just one more page" to find out what happens. Writers design stories with gaps that readers must fill. In horror fiction, for example, a reader's speculations can be more terrifying than the words on the page. Stephen King relies on this tactic in his novel *It*. What makes "It" terrifying is that It's identity is unknown; it could be nothing, or it could be something grotesque. By leaving readers to their own devices, writers like Stephen King allow each reader's psyche to conjure that which he or she fears most.

In contrast to blood-chilling possibilities offered by horror writers, romance and fantasy writers invite readers to escape. The romance novelist, for example, allows the reader to admit inner yearnings and experience them through prose. Successful romance novelists sweep readers off their feet, much as their heroes charm the heroines. Taking escape to another level, fantasy novelists never tell their readers to "be realistic"; instead,

C

D

4

a futuristic Earth with the addition of a technological contraption. Sci-fi novelists appeal to budding scientists and dreamers alike, both of whom are spellbound by speculations on the future of technology and the people who use it. In today's technological age, readers are fascinated by the notion that the dreams of the sci-fi novelists may become the realities of tomorrow.

Novelists connect with their readers by presenting stories that enchant, enrich, and enthrall. Whether through intellectual stimulation, startling speculations, imaginative world-building, or the allure of romance, novelists provide entertainment and enjoyment. Storytelling has captivated humanity for thousands of years, and thanks to the skill of novelists, generations to come will be able to lose themselves in a good book.

F

- A Thesis statement
- B Topic sentence 1 (first example)
- C Topic sentence 2 (second example)
- D Topic sentence 3 (third example)
- E Topic sentence 4 (fourth example)
- F Concluding paragraph

## Read and Write Illustration: Analyze and Respond

### Student Illustration

Inez King

### Empathy



- Skim the title and the first sentence. What do you think the reading will be about?
- *Make Connections*: What is the context (audience and purpose) for this paragraph? How do you know?
- *Make Connections*: When have you felt empathy before?
- *Ask Questions*: Create a guiding question for your reading.



**Guidelines for reading and annotating illustration** Read and annotate this paragraph using these guidelines:

1. Pay attention to vocabulary using marginal notes, context clues, or a dictionary.
2. Find the main point and underline it. (In an illustration, the main point is the general idea that all of the examples illustrate.)
3. Identify supporting details and organizational strategies. Number each supporting example (major support). Note how the examples are organized by circling the transition words.
4. Ask questions and make connections. Remember to connect the paragraph or essay to your own experiences and other things you have read.

\* \* \*

When I first learned the word *empathy*, I couldn't connect my life with the word. Now that I have studied the definition, however, I can recall times when I probably displayed "empathy." While watching the movie *The Color Purple*, without warning, I was crying my eyes out and laughing at the same time. I cried when Sophia was physically attacked and jailed for standing up for her beliefs. I rejoiced when Ms. Celie battled with Mr. Albert and rose above her past. In fact, the same emotions I experienced while viewing *The Color Purple* occur

each time I read a Danielle Steel novel. Each novel draws me into the emotional lives of every character to the point where I feel their joy, anger, and pain. Not only have I experienced “empathy” vicariously through movies and novels, but also through a personal experience. I recall the tragic death of my neighbor. No words could have comforted his wife during her struggle with the loss. I felt her pain and heartbreak, and I could not help but think this could easily happen to me. In the end, “empathy” took a silent approach with me; it ignited tears of sadness and sparked my feelings.



In Chapter 6, you learned how to paraphrase main ideas in order to write a summary. Use your annotations to write a short summary of this paragraph. Remember that a good summary captures the main idea and major supporting details in your own words. The summary refers to the author and uses strong descriptive verbs. When you have completed your summary, share your work with a classmate.



1. Does this paragraph follow the Four Basics of Good Illustration? Explain.
2. Is there any place in the paragraph where you would like more information? Explain.
3. What makes King's examples effective in this paragraph?

\* \* \*

James Carnill

**You**



- Look at the title of the selection. What do you think this essay will be about?
- Read the first paragraph of the essay. What is the context (author and purpose) for this essay? How might the context help you understand the essay better?
- Create a guiding question for your reading of the essay.



**Read and annotate** this essay using the Guidelines for Reading and Annotating Illustration on page 142.



Technology has transformed our generation from social beings into more egocentric people. In his commencement speech titled “This Is Water,” David Foster Wallace makes a valid statement: “It’s a matter of my hardwired default setting, which is to be deeply and literally self-centered.” Technology only strengthens this setting, because its features, more often than not, cater to the consumer. We love to be catered to, everything with *us* in mind. We think about *ourselves* constantly; how we look, how we dress, and what phone we have are all a part of *our* image, and *we* want to be the best. Having the newest phone means everything to *us*, but does it matter to anyone else?

2 Handheld technology grows increasingly more powerful as the days go by. Facebook gets faster, pictures are captured more quickly, and calls are dialed faster. But that Facebook post, it’s about what *you* just did. That picture is of *you*, utilizing the front-facing camera for #SelfieSunday. That call is placed to vent to your friend about “some twit” that just cut *you* off. It’s all about *you*. *You* then wait for likes on the post, *you* wait for someone to comment on the photo of *you*, and *you* all wish that person who cut *you* off would get into a fiery explosion down the road. The Facebook post is “liked,” and then *you* think *you* are liked. The picture comments are, usually, all positive, making *you* feel good. The “twit” *you* labeled that way makes *you* feel better about *your* driving. All of these actions boost our self-esteem for our own benefit. Doing these things makes *us* feel better, while doing very little to promote the common good.

3 In reference to social media, our generation has used these as platforms to promote themselves, but not to their full potential. Most of these services are offered to promote productivity and help the user. Instead, the users, mostly of our generation, have manipulated the apps to favor themselves. With every update we demand it to point to us, and when the update is released, it usually features more things to not only aid the consumer, but also help them exemplify their existence to other users.

4 As a generation, we never become detached from technology. Always on this, constantly on that, tweeting every two minutes, posting every four, and uploading throughout the day. We are always online, through Instagram, Snapchat, Tumblr, or Facebook. We post the most; we look at our own wall, adorned with creations from ourselves. It’s all about *us*, updating where *we* are, what *we* are doing, and how great of a time *we* are having. It makes others feel good for us, but bad for themselves. Although I love seeing your pictures from Turks and Caicos, I’d rather have been there, of course *I* would. *I* want to be there; you shouldn’t have gone, because *I* should have. It’s a vicious cycle of *me*, *Me*, *ME*!

5 Maybe we should ignore ourselves just a little and become more versed in the interests of those around us. The people who we love and care for should be getting more attention. We need to take a step away from the technology; it is a move worth taking. We need to get away from ourselves sometimes, and get away from our image. We need to break free of our egotistical ways and technologies; we need to be more willing to see those around us, and not just ourselves.





In Chapter 6, you learned how to paraphrase main ideas in order to write a summary. Using those guidelines and your annotations, write a summary of Carnill's essay. When you have completed your summary, share your work with a classmate.



1. One of the Four Basics of Good Illustration is that the writing gives enough examples to get the point across to the reader. Do you think Carnill has given enough examples to make his point effectively? Are you convinced by his examples? Why or why not?
2. Carnill uses the pronoun "we" in the first paragraph, but he shifts to "you" in the second. How does his choice of pronoun affect your understanding of the essay? What does it tell you about his audience?
3. Carnill refers to a speech by David Foster Wallace. Explore this speech (you can listen to the speech or find the full text online). How does Carnill's essay support what David Foster Wallace says?
4. What is Carnill's conclusion? Do you agree with him?
5. Can you find examples of technology or social media use that contradict Carnill's thesis? Explain.

## Professional Illustration

Susan Adams

### The Weirdest Job Interview Questions and How to Handle Them

#### Preview

1. Skim the title and the information about the author. What can you learn about the context (author, purpose, and topic) for this essay?
2. What is the strangest question you have ever been asked in a job interview? If you were Ryan (see p. 131), what questions might you expect during an interview with a landscaping company?
3. Create a guiding question for your reading, based on your preview of the selection.

**Read and annotate** the essay carefully, using the Guidelines for Reading and Annotating Illustration on page 142.



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Susan Adams is a senior editor at *Forbes*, a major publisher of business news. Since joining *Forbes* in 1995, Adams has written about a wide variety of subjects, including the art and auction market. Previously, she was a reporter for the *MacNeil/Lehrer NewsHour*. Adams holds a B.A. from Brown University and a J.D. from Yale University Law School. Every week, Adams writes an advice column for *Forbes.com*, and the following is one of those columns. In it, she gives examples of some of the stranger questions that come up in job interviews.

I once interviewed for a job with a documentary producer who made boring if well-meaning films for public TV. By way of preparation, I studied up on the producer's projects and gave a lot of thought to how my interests and experience dovetailed with his. Our chat went swimmingly until he asked me a question that caught me completely off guard: "Who is your favorite comedian?"

2 Wait a second, I thought. Comedy is the opposite of what this guy does. My mind did backflips while I desperately searched for a comedian who might be a favorite of a tweedy, bearded liberal Democrat. After maybe 30 seconds too long, I blurted out my personal favorite: David Alan Grier, an African-American funnyman on the weekly Fox TV show *In Living Color*. My potential boss looked at me blankly as I babbled about how much I liked Grier's characters, especially Antoine Merriweather, one of the two gay reviewers in the brilliantly hilarious sketch "Men on Film."

3 Wrong answer. I had derailed the interview. My potential employer asked me a few more **perfunctory** questions and then saw me to the door.

**perfunctory:**  
quick, indifferent,  
superficial

4 We all prepare studiously for job interviews, doing our homework about our potential employers and compiling short but detailed stories to illustrate our accomplishments, but how in the world do we prep for an off-the-wall interview question?

5 Glassdoor.com, a three-year-old Sausalito, California, website that bills itself as "the TripAdvisor for careers," has compiled a list of "top oddball interview questions" for two years running. Glassdoor gets its information directly from employees who work at 120,000 companies.

6 Crazy as it sounds, an interviewer at Schlumberger, the giant Houston oilfield services provider, once asked some poor job applicant, "What was your best *MacGyver* moment?," referring to a 1980s action-adventure TV show. At Goldman Sachs, the question was, "If you were shrunk to the size of a pencil and put in a blender, how would you get out?" At Deloitte, "How many ridges [are there] around a quarter?" At AT&T, "If you were a superhero, which superhero would you be?" And at Boston Consulting: "How many hair salons are there in Japan?"

7 No matter where you apply for work, there is a chance you could get a question from left field. According to Rusty Rueff—a consultant at Glassdoor who

is the author of *Talent Force: A New Manifesto for the Human Side of Business* and former head of human resources at PepsiCo and Electronic Arts—most job applicants are **woefully** unprepared for off-the-wall questions. “Ninety percent of people don’t know how to deal with them,” he says. Like me, they freeze and their minds go blank.

**woefully:** seriously; regrettably

8 To deal with that, Rueff advises, first you have to realize that the interviewer isn’t trying to make you look stupid, as stupid as the question may seem. For instance, the *MacGyver* question is meant as an invitation to talk about how you got out of a tough jam. “They’re not looking for you to tell about the time you took out your ballpoint and did a **tracheotomy**,” Rueff notes. Rather, you can probably extract an answer from one of the achievement stories you prepared in advance.

**tracheotomy:** a cut made into the throat to open a blocked airway

9 With a question like “How many hair salons are there in Japan,” the interviewer is giving you an opportunity to demonstrate your thought processes. Rueff says you should think out loud, like the contestants on *Who Wants to Be a Millionaire?* You might start by saying, We’d have to know the population of Japan, and then we’d have to figure out what percentage of them get their hair done and how often. Rueff says it’s fine to pull out a pen and paper and start doing some calculations right there in the interview.

10 Connie Thanasoulis-Cerrachio, a career services consultant at Vault.com, agrees with Rueff. “These are called case interview questions,” she says. Another example, which may seem equally impossible to answer: Why are manhole covers round?

11 In fact the manhole cover question, and “How would you move Mt. Fuji?,” were brought to light in a 2003 book, *How Would You Move Mount Fuji? Microsoft’s Cult of the Puzzle: How the World’s Smartest Company Selects the Most Creative Thinkers*. Microsoft’s **grueling** interview process often includes such problem-solving and logic questions. Just start thinking through the question, out loud, Thanasoulis-Cerrachio advises. “I would say, a round manhole cover could keep the framework of the tunnel stronger, because a round frame is much stronger than a square frame,” she suggests. In fact, there are several reasons, including the fact that a round lid can’t fall into the hole the way a square one can and the fact that it can be rolled.

**grueling:** difficult; tiring

12 Business schools teach students how to deal with case interview questions, and Vault has even put out a book on the subject, *Vault Guide to the Case Interview*.

13 Other weird-seeming questions, like “If you were a brick in a wall, which brick would you be and why,” or “If you could be any animal, what would you be and why,” are really just invitations to show a side of your personality. Thanasoulis-Cerrachio says a friend who is chief executive of a market research company used to ask applicants what kind of car they would be. “She wanted someone fast, who thought quickly,” Thanasoulis-Cerrachio says. “She wanted someone who wanted to be a Maserati, not a Bentley.” For the brick question, Thanasoulis-Cerrachio advises saying something like, “I would want to be a foundational brick because I’m a solid person. You can build on my experience and I will never let you down.”

14 According to Rueff and Thanasoulis-Cerrachio, my comedian question was also a behavioral question, a test of my personality. “You gave a fine answer,” says Rueff. Maybe. But I didn’t get the job.



## Check Comprehension

1. What question was the author asked during her job interview in paragraph 1? How did the interview end?
2. How does Rusty Rueff advise applicants to handle strange questions?
3. According to Adams, why do employers ask these strange questions?

## Think Critically

You learned in Chapter 6 that an inference is a logical conclusion we make based on the evidence provided in a reading. Consider what Adams says in her essay to determine whether the following statements are true or false.

1. We cannot really prepare for the strange questions we may get in a job interview. **False**
2. Most employers have one right answer that they are looking for when they ask a strange question. **False**

## Summarize

Using the guidelines from Chapter 6 (p. 94) and your annotations, write a summary of Adams' essay. Remember that your summary will include the main point and major supporting details, written in your own words. When you have finished, compare your summary with a classmate's version.

## Writing Strategies in Action: Hypothetical Examples

Review the examples provided in Adams' essay, and then answer the following questions:

1. Which examples include quotes? For each writer quoted by Adams, identify the speaker's credentials.
2. Find one hypothetical example. What is one clue that the example is hypothetical?
3. Should an entire illustration essay rely on hypothetical examples? Why or why not?
4. Look at each of the following nonspecific nouns. Find a specific proper noun that Adams uses with or instead of the nonspecific one in her essay. The first one is done for you.
  - An African American comedian **David Alan Grier**
  - Online site about careers and interviews **Glassdoor.com**
  - A consultant **Rusty Rueff**
  - A communications company **AT&T**
  - A software company **Microsoft**
  - A career-services consultant **Connie Thanasoulis-Cerrachio**

## Build Vocabulary: The Language of Specificity

Study the vocabulary words defined in the margin of Adams' essay. What do the following words have in common?

swimmingly      studiously      woefully

These words are examples of **adverbs**, or words that describe an action. Many adverbs end with an *-ly* suffix, as these examples do. Adverbs help a writer make the meaning of an action more specific. For example, notice that the writer here says that people "prepare studiously" for interviews. Why is "prepare studiously" more specific than just "prepare"?

### Use *-ly* Adverbs

1. Find three additional examples of adverbs in the essay that make the writer's meaning more specific. **probably, equally, quickly, directly, brilliantly, especially**
2. Write three sentences of your own, using *-ly* adverbs.

## Think, Discuss, and Respond

1. Write about your own experiences with job interviews, giving examples of anything you found challenging—the stress of preparing for the interview, questions or awkward moments during the interview, and so on. If you were able to address these challenges in any way, explain how. (If you have not had many job interviews, write about the experiences of a friend or relative.)
2. Adams discusses how unusual interview questions can provide useful information. Come up with at least three odd interview questions, and explain how each one would provide an employer with helpful information.

Dianne Hales

## Why Are We So Angry?

### Preview

1. Skim the title and the information about the author. What can you learn about the context (audience, purpose, and topic) for this essay?
2. What makes you angry? How do you express your anger? Has your anger ever gotten you in trouble?
3. Create a guiding question for your reading.

**Read and annotate** this essay carefully, using the Guidelines for Reading and Annotating Illustration on page 142.



ROBERT E. HALES

Dianne Hales specializes in writing about mental health, fitness, and other issues related to the body and mind. A former contributing editor for *Parade* magazine, she has also written several college-level health textbooks. In her critically acclaimed book *Just Like a Woman* (2000), she examined assumptions about the biological differences between women and men. Most recently, she authored *La Bella Lingua: My Love Affair with Italian, the World's Most Enchanting Language* (2009). Both the

American Psychiatric Association and the American Psychological Association have presented Hales with awards for excellence in writing. In addition, she has earned an Exceptional Media Merit Award (EMMA) from the National Women's Political Caucus for health reporting. She lives in Marin County, California.

In the following article, Hales uses vivid examples to illustrate the “rage” phenomenon. She reports on the causes and results of the apparent increase in out-of-control anger—and explains what can be done to relieve the problem.

Something snapped inside Jerry Sola during his evening commute through the Chicago suburbs two years ago. When the driver in front of the fifty-one-year-old salesman suddenly slammed on his brakes, Sola got so incensed that he gunned his engine to cut in front of the man. Still steaming when both cars stopped at a red light, Sola grabbed a golf club from the backseat and got out.

2 “I was just about to smash his windshield or do him some damage,” the brawny, 6-foot-1 former police officer recalls. “Then it hit me: ‘What in God’s name am I doing? I’m really a nice, helpful guy. What if I killed a man, went to jail, and destroyed two families over a crazy, trivial thing?’ I got back into my car and drove away.”

3 Like Sola, more and more Americans are feeling pushed to the breaking point. The American Automobile Association’s Foundation for Traffic Safety says incidents of violently aggressive driving—which some dub “mad driver disease”—rose 7 percent a year in the 1990s. Airlines are reporting more outbursts of sky rage. And sideline rage has become widespread: A Pennsylvania kids’ football game ended in a brawl involving more than one hundred coaches, players, parents, and fans. In a particularly tragic incident that captured national attention, a Massachusetts father—angered over rough play during his son’s hockey practice—beat another father to death as their children watched.

4 No one seems immune to the anger epidemic. Women fly off the handle just as often as men, though they’re less likely to get physical. The young and the infamous, such as musicians Sean “Puffy” Combs and Courtney Love—both sentenced to anger-management classes for violent outbursts—may seem more **volatile**, but even senior citizens have erupted into “line rage” and pushed ahead of others simply because they felt they had “waited long enough” in their lives.

**volatile:** explosive



5 “People no longer hold themselves accountable for their bad behavior,” says Doris Wilde Helmering, a therapist and author of *Sense Ability*. “They blame anyone and everything for their anger.”

6 **It’s a mad, mad world.** Violent outbursts are just as likely to occur in leafy suburbs as in crowded cities, and even **idyllic** vacation spots are not immune. “Everyone everywhere seems to be hotter under the collar these days,” observes Sybil Evans, a conflict-resolution expert in New York City, who singles out three primary culprits: time, technology, and tension. “Americans are working longer hours than anyone else in the world. The cell phones and pagers that were supposed to make our lives easier have put us on call 24/7/365. Since we’re always running, we’re tense and low on patience. And the less patience we have, the less we monitor what we say to people and how we treat them.”

**idyllic:** peaceful

7 **Ironically**, the recent boom times may have brought out the worst in some people. “Never have so many with so much been so unhappy,” observes Leslie Charles, author of *Why Is Everyone So Cranky?* “There are more of us than ever, all wanting the same space, goods, services, or attention. Everyone thinks, ‘Me first. I don’t have time to be polite.’ We’ve lost not only our civility but our tolerance for inconvenience.”

**ironically:** opposite to what is or might be expected

8 The sheer complexity of our lives also has shortened our collective fuse. We rely on computers that crash, drive on roads that gridlock, place calls to machines that put us on endless hold. “It’s not any one thing but lots of little things that make people feel like they don’t have control of their lives,” says Jane Middleton-Moz, a therapist and author. “A sense of helplessness is what triggers rage. It’s why people end up kicking ATM machines.”

9 **Getting a grip.** When his lawn mower wouldn’t start, a St. Louis man got so angry that he picked it up by the handle, smashed it against the patio, and tore off each of its wheels. Playing golf, he sometimes became so enraged that he threw his clubs 50 feet up the fairway and into the trees and had to get someone to retrieve them. In anger-therapy sessions with Doris Wilde Helmering, he learned that such outbursts accomplish nothing. “Venting” may make you feel better—but only for a moment.

10 **Catharsis** is worse than useless,” says Brad Bushman, a psychology professor at Iowa State University whose research has shown that letting anger out makes people more aggressive, not less. “Many people think of anger as the psychological equivalent of the steam in a pressure cooker: It has to be released, or it will explode. That’s not true. The people who react by hitting, kicking, screaming, and swearing just feel more angry.”

**catharsis:** release of emotional tension

11 Over time, temper tantrums sabotage physical health as well as psychological **equanimity**. By churning out stress hormones like adrenaline, chronic anger revs the body into a state of combat readiness, multiplying the risk for stroke and heart attack—even in healthy individuals. In one study by Duke University researchers, young women with “*Jerry Springer Show*–type anger,” who tended to slam doors, curse, and throw things in a fury, had higher cholesterol levels than those who reacted more calmly.

**equanimity:** balance

**epiphany:** a sudden understanding of something

12 *How do you tame a toxic temper?* The first step is to figure out what's really making you angry. Usually the rude sales clerk is the final straw that unleashes bottled-up fury over a more difficult issue, such as a divorce or a domineering boss. Next, monitor yourself for early signs of exhaustion or overload. While stress alone doesn't cause a blow-up, it makes you more vulnerable to overreacting.

13 When you feel yourself getting angry, control your tongue and your brain. "Like any feeling, anger lasts only about three seconds," says Doris Wilde Helmering. "What keeps it going is your negative thinking." As long as you focus on who or what irritated you—like the oaf who rammed that grocery cart into your heels—you'll stay angry. "Once you come to understand that you're driving your own anger with your thoughts," adds Helmering, "you can stop it."

14 Since his roadside **epiphany**, Jerry Sola has conscientiously worked to rein in his rage. "I am a changed person," he says, "especially behind the wheel. I don't listen to the news on the car radio. Instead, I put on nice, soothing music. I force myself to smile at rude drivers. And if I feel myself getting angry, I ask a simple question: 'Why should I let a person I'm never going to see again control my mood and ruin my whole day?'"

### Check Comprehension

1. According to Hales, why do angry outbursts seem to be increasing?
2. Do experts think it is a good idea to release anger in a fit of screaming or by throwing things?
3. What are three steps that Hales recommends for controlling anger?

### Think Critically

1. Based on the sources of increased stress and anger listed in paragraph 6, do you think the anger issue exists worldwide? Explain.
2. Is it possible for our society to reduce its overall level of anger? Explain.
3. What is the tone of Hales' article? What words help you identify her tone?

### Paraphrase

In her essay, Hales addresses important questions: *who* is angry, *where* anger occurs, and some reasons *why* it seems we are angry. Paraphrase her answers, making sure that you explain her ideas without borrowing her language or sentence structure. Introduce your paraphrase with a signal phrase and include a citation. For more on paraphrase, see Chapter 6 (p. 94).

1. WHO: "No one seems immune to the anger epidemic" (para. 4).
2. WHERE: "Violent outbursts are just as likely to occur in leafy suburbs as in crowded cities, and even idyllic vacation spots are not immune" (para. 6).
3. WHY: "The sheer complexity of our lives also has shortened our collective fuse" (para. 8).

## Writing Strategies in Action: Provide Credentials and Quote Experts

For each of the following experts mentioned in Hales' essay, find and list the expert's credentials. The first one has been done for you.

- Sybil Evans *conflict-resolution expert in New York City*
- Leslie Charles *author of *Why is Everyone So Cranky?**
- Jane Middleton-Moz *therapist and author*
- Brad Bushman *psychology professor at Iowa State University*
- Doris Wilde Helmering *therapist and author of *Sense Ability**

Now consider these questions:

1. Why do the writers need to include the credentials of the authorities or experts they quote?
2. Would Hales' examples have worked as well if she had cited one of the following as her experts? Why or why not? Oprah Winfrey, Tim Tebow, Mariah Carey, Bill Gates, Jeb Bush

### Quote an Expert

Choose one idea from Hales' essay that connects with your life. In a paragraph, quote that idea. Make sure you have each of the following:

1. A signal phrase
2. A citation
3. Beginning and ending quotation marks
4. The quote, copied exactly. To check the accuracy of your quote, do a quick word count. First, look at the original sentence(s) in Hales' essay. How many words are in it? Now check your quote. How many words are in it? If the number of words in a quote does not match the number of words in the original, look back to see what word(s) you may have left out.
5. Hales' credentials.

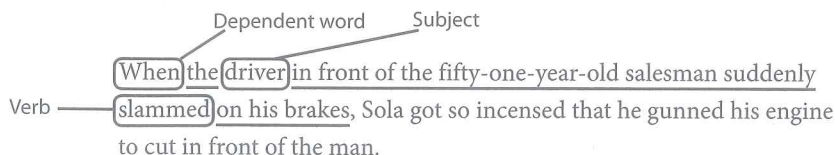
## Explore Grammar: Commas after Introductory Dependent Clauses

Look at the following sentence from the essay:

When the driver in front of the fifty-one-year-old salesman suddenly slammed on his brakes, Sola got so incensed that he gunned his engine to cut in front of the man.



Did you notice the comma after the word “brakes”? This sentence begins with a dependent clause. A **dependent clause** begins with a dependent word, and it has a subject and a verb. Look at the dependent clause, which is underlined below:



When a sentence begins with a dependent clause, the dependent clause is followed by a comma. (For more on dependent words, dependent clauses, and commas, see Chapters 17 and 24.)

### Use Commas with Dependent Clauses

Add commas after the dependent clauses in the following sentences. When you have finished, check your work by looking back at the essay.

1. Since we're always running we're tense and low on patience.
2. When his lawn mower wouldn't start a St. Louis man got so angry that he picked it up by the handle, smashed it against the patio, and tore off each of its wheels.
3. When you feel yourself getting angry control your tongue and your brain.
4. If I feel myself getting angry I ask a simple question.

### Think, Discuss, and Respond

1. Find one piece of advice in Hales' essay that makes sense to you. In a paragraph, explain how you might apply that advice in your own life, giving at least two specific examples. Quote the advice from Hales in the paragraph, making sure that it is properly copied, punctuated, and cited.
2. Do you think our society is becoming angrier? Develop your answer in a paragraph with at least three examples, making sure that at least one of your examples comes from Hales' essay. Use a quotation that is copied accurately and cited correctly.

### Extend and Connect: Write Your Own Illustration

1. Susan Adams suggests that job interviewers ask specific questions in order to understand an applicant's creativity and logical thinking. Imagine an employer who knows that a job is very stressful. The interviewer wants to discover how applicants handle stress and whether they lose control of their anger. What questions might the interviewer ask to find this information? Explain, using specific examples.
2. James Carnill suggests that our use of technology makes us self-centered. How does technology use relate to anger? Does being self-centered make us more likely to explode in anger? Write an essay in which you give examples of anger related to technology.

3. Do you think students on your campus have problems managing anger? Before you answer this question, consider people on your campus who might qualify as experts on this question. Interview at least three people, making sure to note each person's credentials. Develop your answer in an essay, using specific examples and quotes from the people you interviewed.
4. Inez King gives examples of empathy in her paragraph on page 142. Can technology help people develop empathy, or is it more likely to make people self-centered, as suggested by James Carnill? Write an essay that explores the relationship between technology and empathy, providing specific examples to support your thesis.

## CHECKLIST

### Writing an Illustration Essay



#### NARROW AND EXPLORE YOUR TOPIC (see Chapter 2)

- ☐ Make the topic more specific.
- ☐ Use prewriting techniques to get ideas about your narrow topic.



#### DRAFT A TOPIC SENTENCE OR THESIS STATEMENT (see Chapter 4)

- ☐ Decide what you want your readers to know about the topic.

#### SUPPORT YOUR POINT (see Chapter 4)

- ☐ Find examples and details that will illustrate your main idea.

#### WRITE A FULL DRAFT (see Chapter 4)

- ☐ Make a plan that puts the examples in logical order.
- ☐ Include the topic sentence (paragraph), an introduction, a thesis (essay), and enough examples to make your point.
- ☐ Add a concluding sentence or concluding paragraph.



#### REVISE YOUR DRAFT (see Chapter 5)

- ☐ Make sure you have covered the Four Basics of Good Illustration.
- ☐ Make sure your readers have all the information they need to connect the examples to the point.
- ☐ Make sure you have included transitions to move readers smoothly from one example to the next.



#### EDIT YOUR REVISED DRAFT (see Chapter 5)

- ☐ Correct errors in grammar, spelling, word usage, and punctuation.
- ☐ Make sure your document is formatted correctly.